WEEKEND WARRIOR

GO FORTH AND BE AWESOME

1 COOL YOUR JETS

"As you approach the first turn, pick your brake marker—the spot on the road where you're going to start slowing down—and get ready. There should be reference points on the outside of the track."

2 PICK A LINE

"Shift your weight to the inside corner and drop your knee as you begin to tip the bike. This lets you know how far you're leaning, but more important, it helps you stabilize yourself if the front tire starts to slide."

3 GET TECHNICAL

"You can only drive a car so hard, but on a motorcycle, you do most of the steering with your body. Being able to hold the right positions and weight your foot pegs correctly all comes down to skill."

4 HOLD STRONG

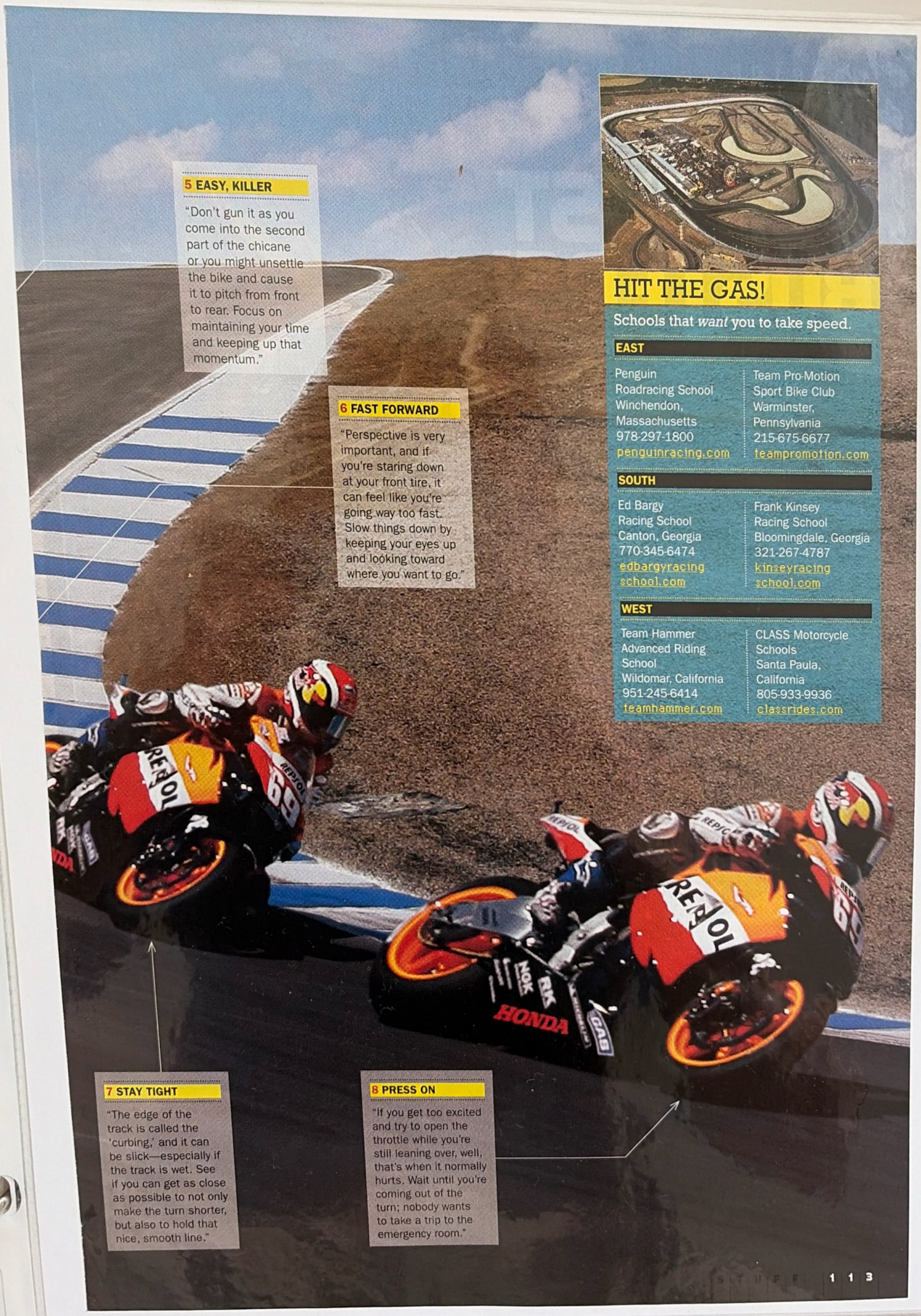
"As the bike stands back up between turns, the fatter parts of your tires will be touching the asphalt. Even though you'll have good traction again, try to relax and concentrate on getting a good exit."

MOTORCYCLE CRASH COURSE

Two-time Red Bull USGP champ Nicky Hayden lays down some racing know-how.

Can you say "sponsors"?

Hauling ass on the back of a high-end motorcycle is not easy, especially when it can accelerate like a bottle rocket, corner like a wild animal and hit 215 mph like it ain't no thang. But it's behind the narrow handlebars and sleek gauges of one of these monsters that MotoGP phenom Nicky Hayden really shines. And while you probably won't get a chance to race against him anytime soon, you can still learn a thing or two from his flawless riding technique. Peel off that helmet and listen up as he takes you through a chicane turn, one of the sport's most technical maneuvers. And when you're done reading, tear this magazine from your bleached knuckles and get yourself to one of the nation's top street-racing schools. Where else can you practice what Hayden preaches without killing yourself or getting a gargantuan ticket?



5 EASY, KILLER

"Don't gun it as you come into the second part of the chicane or you might unsettle the bike and cause it to pitch from front to rear. Focus on maintaining your time and keeping up that momentum."

6 FAST FORWARD

"Perspective is very important, and if you're staring down at your front tire, it can feel like you're going way too fast. Slow things down by keeping your eyes up and looking toward where you want to go."

HIT THE GAS!

Schools that *want* you to take speed.

EAST

Penguin Roadracing School
Winchendon, Massachusetts
978-297-1800
penguinracing.com

Team Pro-Motion Sport Bike Club
Warminster, Pennsylvania
215-675-6677
teampromotion.com

SOUTH

Ed Bargy Racing School
Canton, Georgia
770-345-6474
edbargyracingschool.com

Frank Kinsey Racing School
Bloomingdale, Georgia
321-267-4787
kinseyracingschool.com

WEST

Team Hammer Advanced Riding School
Wildomar, California
951-245-6414
teamhammer.com

CLASS Motorcycle Schools
Santa Paula, California
805-933-9936
classrides.com

7 STAY TIGHT

"The edge of the track is called the 'curbing,' and it can be slick—especially if the track is wet. See if you can get as close as possible to not only make the turn shorter, but also to hold that nice, smooth line."

8 PRESS ON

"If you get too excited and try to open the throttle while you're still leaning over, well, that's when it normally hurts. Wait until you're coming out of the turn; nobody wants to take a trip to the emergency room."